

Unit 4 Assessment

Cartographer's Mini-Portfolio

Grade 3 Social Studies | Synthesis 1: The Cartographer's Review | Week 11

Name: _____

Date: _____

Part A: Review Check

Choose the best answer.

1. What makes something a primary source?

- A. It was written by an expert
- B. It is very old
- C. It was made during the time it describes
- D. It has a lot of details

2. How are exploration and maps connected?

- A. Maps were invented before exploration
- B. Explorers found new places, and mapmakers recorded them
- C. Maps replaced the need for exploration
- D. Exploration and maps are not connected

3. Which map would best answer the question, 'How high are the mountains in this area?'

- A. Political map
- B. Population map
- C. Elevation map
- D. Road map

4. A navigator used a compass and an astrolabe. The compass helped with _____ and the astrolabe helped with _____.

- A. direction; how far north or south
- B. speed; how deep the water was
- C. time; how hot it was
- D. language; how fast the wind blew

Part B: Portfolio Response

Answer in complete sentences.

5. Think about a question a map could help you answer (for example: 'Which region gets the most rain?' or 'How far is it from Florida to Texas?'). Write the question, then name which type of map would best answer it and explain why.

6. If an explorer from the 1500s drew a map of a coastline, that map is a primary source. Explain why, and describe one thing we could learn from it that a modern textbook might leave out.

Part C: Virtue Reflection

7. Honesty is the virtue for this synthesis unit. Explain how a curator shows honesty when choosing the best map or source for an exhibit.

Section	Points
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Part A: Review Check (Q1–4)	4 pts
Part B: Portfolio Response (Q5–6)	12 pts
Part C: Virtue Reflection (Q7)	4 pts
Total	20 pts

Unit 4 Assessment — Answer Key

Cartographer's Mini-Portfolio

Part A (4 pts, 1 each)

1. C — Made during the time it describes
2. B — Explorers found places, mapmakers recorded them
3. C — Elevation map
4. A — Direction; how far north or south

Part B (12 pts, 6 each)

5. **Secure:** Writes a clear question, names correct map type (e.g., elevation for mountain height, physical for rivers), explains why that map answers the question. **Developing:** Question + map type but weak explanation. **Beginning:** Vague or wrong map type.
6. **Secure:** Explains primary = made during the event, gives specific detail an explorer's map might show (rough coastlines, handwritten notes, specific harbors) that a modern textbook would summarize or skip. **Developing:** Explains primary source correctly but vague on unique details. **Beginning:** Incomplete.

Part C (4 pts)

7. **Secure:** Honesty = choosing the map/source that truly answers the question, even if another looks fancier; admitting when a source has limits. **Developing:** General honesty connection. **Beginning:** Names virtue only.